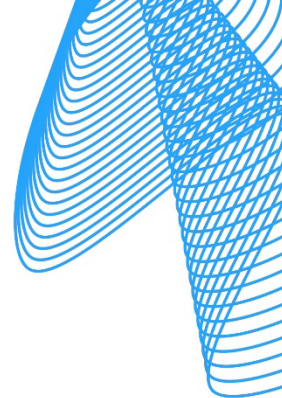


# Task 1: Audience Research & Design Plan

## User Persona



**Phoebe  
Reilson**  
Website Designer



### Profile

I am a 40-year-old progressing student at MCAST and I regularly use the MCAST website to access course information, timetables, student resources, and library services. Most of my browsing is done on a mobile device, so I value a website that is easy to navigate and provides quick access to important information. I get frustrated when information is difficult to find or when pages contain too much text.

### Goals

The goal for this website is to find any course information quickly.  
Pain Points: I find the navigation of the website difficult to use when I am using it on my mobile and need to navigate into many pages to find the information document

### Education

2024-2026  
Malta College of Arts, Science & Technology  
Advanced Diploma in Digital Design

2023-2024  
Malta College of Art, Science & Technology  
Diploma in Media

### Pin Points

I find navigations difficult as there are too many pages to reach information, pages with too much text, and poor usability on mobile devices.

### Result

The survey respondents were primarily MCAST students aged 18-20, providing valuable insight into how students interact with the MCAST website. Most participants reported using the website occasionally, while others either visited it frequently or not at all. The main reasons for accessing the website were to find course information and use library resources. Mobile devices were the most common method of access, followed by laptops and desktop computers. User feedback on usability was generally mixed, with some finding the website easy to navigate, while others felt neutral or experienced difficulties. Respondents suggested several improvements, including better accessibility features, a clearer navigation menu, a more organized layout, and increased use of images to improve the overall user experience.

### Digital Skills

I am comfortable using a laptop for browsers, online forms and common digital tools.

- Microsoft 365
- Adobe Creative Cloud
- Visual Studio Code
- Git Hub

## User Feedback

The selected audience for the website redesign is prospective students. To understand the needs and expectations of users accessing MCAST information, feedback was collected through an online survey. The existing respondents were mainly MCAST students aged 18–65. Although this group mainly represents younger students, their experience of using the MCAST website provides useful information regarding navigation, accessibility, content and device usage.

The survey results show that 66.7% of respondents visited the MCAST website sometimes, while the remaining respondents were split between visiting it often and not at all. Course information and library resources were the main reasons for using the site. Half of respondents accessed the website using a mobile phone, 33.3% used a laptop and 16.7% used a desktop computer. For usability, 33.3% found the website easy to use, 50% were neutral and 16.7% found it difficult. Suggested improvements included clearer navigation, better accessibility, a more organised layout and greater use of relevant images.

Survey link:

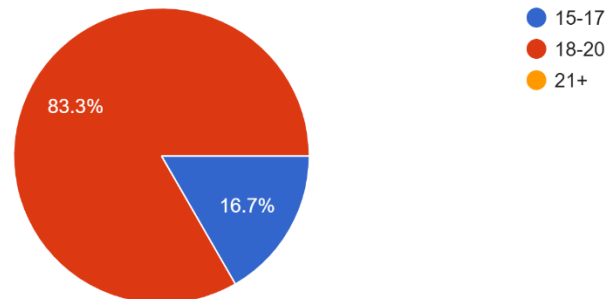
[https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1fHykrmlVFfXF\\_s10jmaf2jeAGjSqeQT6WCzsQXdimPs/edit](https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1fHykrmlVFfXF_s10jmaf2jeAGjSqeQT6WCzsQXdimPs/edit)

## Research Summery

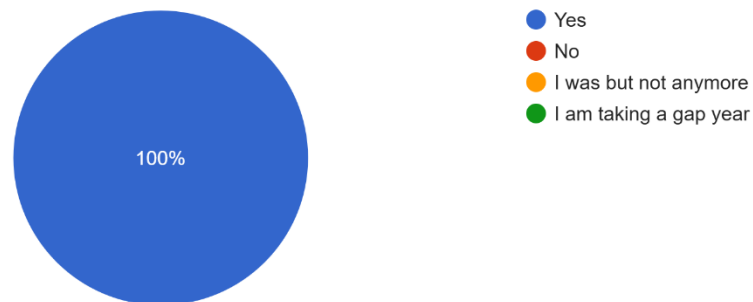
The audience research highlighted several requirements that influenced both the user persona and the website redesign. Respondents mainly used the MCAST website to locate course information and student resources, so the persona focuses on a user who needs to find important information quickly. Half of the respondents accessed the website using a mobile phone, which identified responsiveness as an important requirement for future development. Feedback also showed that users wanted clearer navigation, better accessibility, a more organised layout and more relevant imagery. These findings informed the decision to simplify the navigation, improve visual hierarchy, divide content into clearer sections and use images to support the written information. The persona therefore represents a digitally confident prospective student who expects a website to be easy to scan, consistent between pages and efficient when locating courses or contact details.

## Survey Results

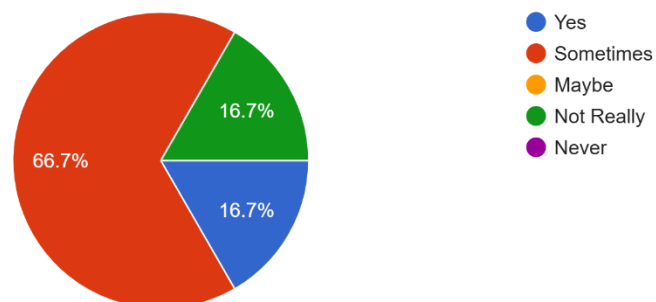
Age group  
6 responses



Are you a student at MCAST?  
6 responses



Do you visit the MCAST Website?  
6 responses



If yes for what reasons do you visit the MCAST Website?

5 responses

To check course information and library resources

To check any necessary information

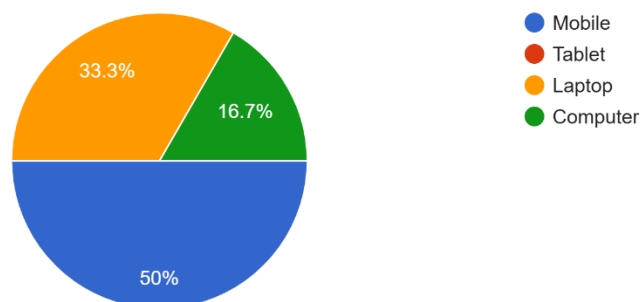
Course details

For info about my course

course requirements

What device do you mostly visit the website on?

6 responses



For what reasons do you use the MCAST Website?

6 responses

To check student resources and schedules

To find the information or keep updated with events and the timetable

Course details

For info on my course and future courses

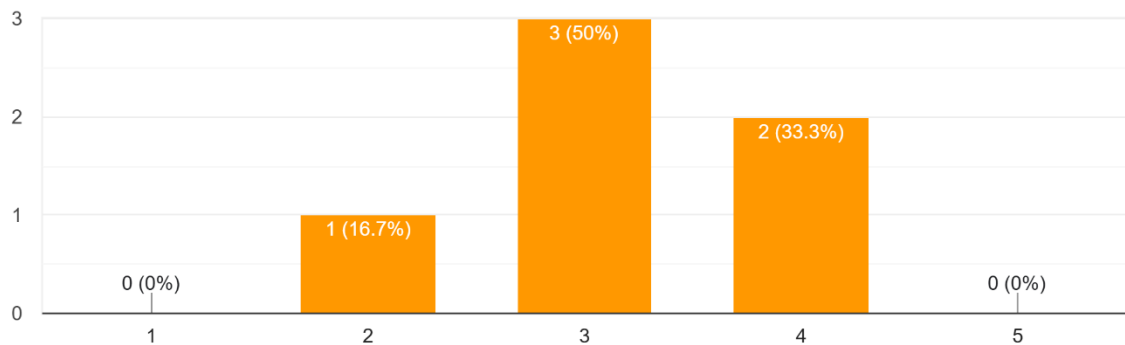
school info

Course and lessons

## Carlene Attard- DDN 4.2A Website Design Synoptic

Rank how easy is it to use the MCAST Website from 1 (Very Hard)- 5 (Very Easy)

6 responses



Your thought about the website. If you had to change anything on the website what would it be and why?

6 responses

The menu panel because it glitches when opened on mobile and there are too much text cramped

The layout because it looks messy and sloppy, and as well make a better navigation to help new students have better access

Menu on mobile

Accessibility

text and navigation

To make finding information easier

Would you improve any of the elements on the website such as colour, text/info, images, etc..

6 responses

A cleaner layout, more useful information, more negative space and more images that guide to sections

Yes, the text should be changed to be more readable, and the images can be smaller.

Visual elements are quite good, however might introduce a dark mode and adjust colours accordingly

No

images and text

More images

# Website Review and Improvement plan

## Strengths and Areas of Improvement

| Strengths                                         | Areas for Improvement                                             |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Contact information is relatively easy to locate. | Visual hierarchy needs to be stronger.                            |
| Typography is generally consistent.               | More relevant images are needed.                                  |
| The original layout is simple and uncluttered.    | Accessibility needs improvement.                                  |
|                                                   | Interactive contact and social-media elements should be improved. |
|                                                   | Text size/readability and navigation clarity should be improved.  |

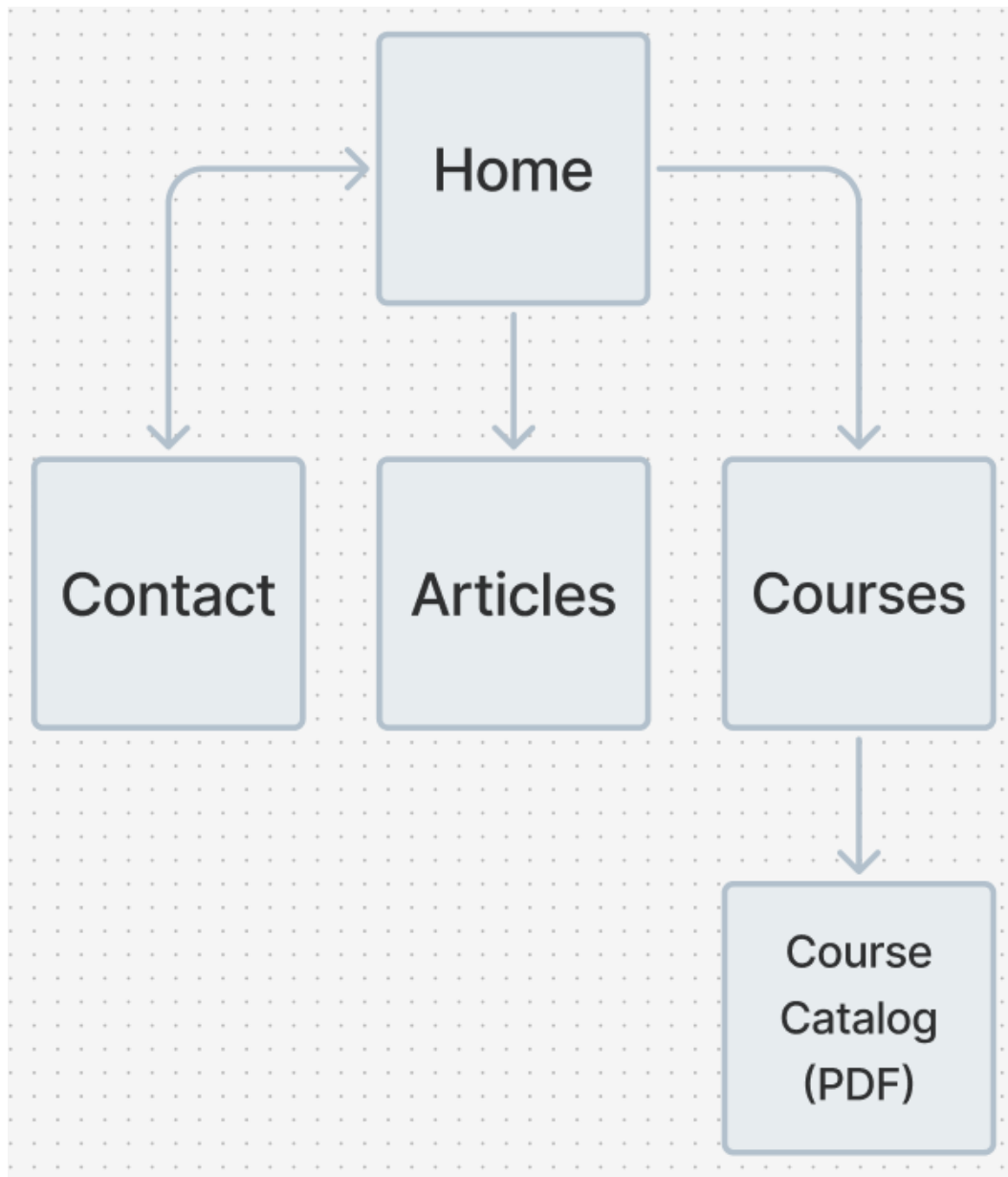
## Improvement Plan

| Issue Identified                                                  | Evidence / Reason                                                                                          | Proposed Improvement                                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Visual hierarchy needs to be stronger.                            | The content is not clearly organised, and uneven alignment makes important information harder to identify. | Split the content into clear sections using headings and bullet points, and use a consistent grid to improve alignment |
| More relevant images are needed.                                  | Too much negative space and limited imagery make some areas look empty.                                    | Add relevant images and icons to make better use of the available space and make the pages more visually engaging.     |
| Accessibility needs improvement.                                  | Similar colour schemes, nowhere for the user to fill in their information and no keyboard navigation.      | Improve keyboard accessibility by allowing users to navigate and use the search button with the keyboard.              |
| Interactive contact and social-media elements should be improved. | Users may not easily find the college's location or social-media information.                              | On the Contact page, add a section where users can access MCAST locations and social-media links.                      |
| Text size/readability and navigation clarity should be improved.  | Some text is too small, making it difficult for some users to read.                                        | Increase the text size and make it consistent across each page.                                                        |

## Site Map Wireframe and Style Guidelines

### Site Map

The following wireframes show the planned layout, consistent navigation and content placement for all three required pages: Home, Contact and Articles.

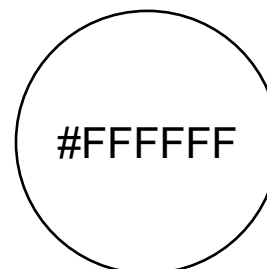
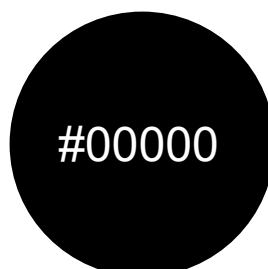


<https://www.figma.com/board/Sh7JMwYBCzSzPYQXM2sFtd/WB-Task-1-Diagram?node-id=0-1&p=f&t=HLyLK7kYFuGZxOzH-0>

## Style Guide

| Design Element   | Specification                                                                                                                                                   |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Colour palette   | #000146 (MCAST navy), #000000 (black), #FFFFFF (white).                                                                                                         |
| Typography       | Times New Roman. H1: 32px bold; H2: 24px bold; body: 18px; navigation: 16-30px depending on implementation.                                                     |
| Spacing          | Use consistent section spacing. Main content uses clear margins and padding; form fields use approximately 12px internal padding and 20px vertical separation.  |
| Navigation links | Normal: white text on navy background. Hover: underline for toolbar links.                                                                                      |
| Primary button   | Normal: navy background with white text. Hover: slight upward movement / darker feedback state.                                                                 |
| Secondary button | Normal: white/light background with navy border and navy text. Hover: slight upward movement.                                                                   |
| Imagery          | Use relevant MCAST photographs. General content images approximately 429 x 286 px. Hero image spans page width and uses crop/object-fit to maintain proportion. |
| Accessibility    | Meaningful alt text on images, labelled form controls, clear heading hierarchy and sufficient contrast between text and background.                             |

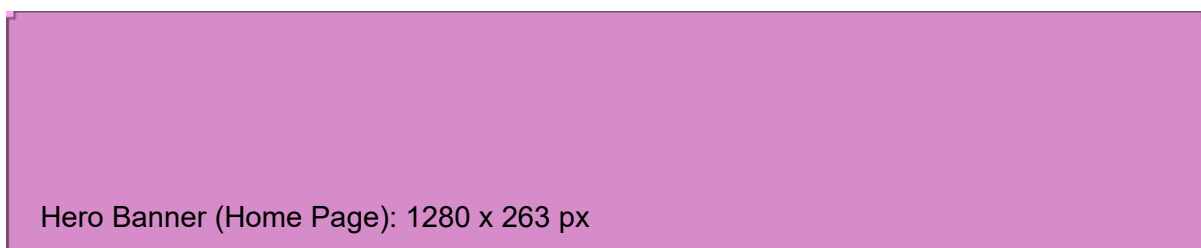
## Colour Scheme Hex Codes



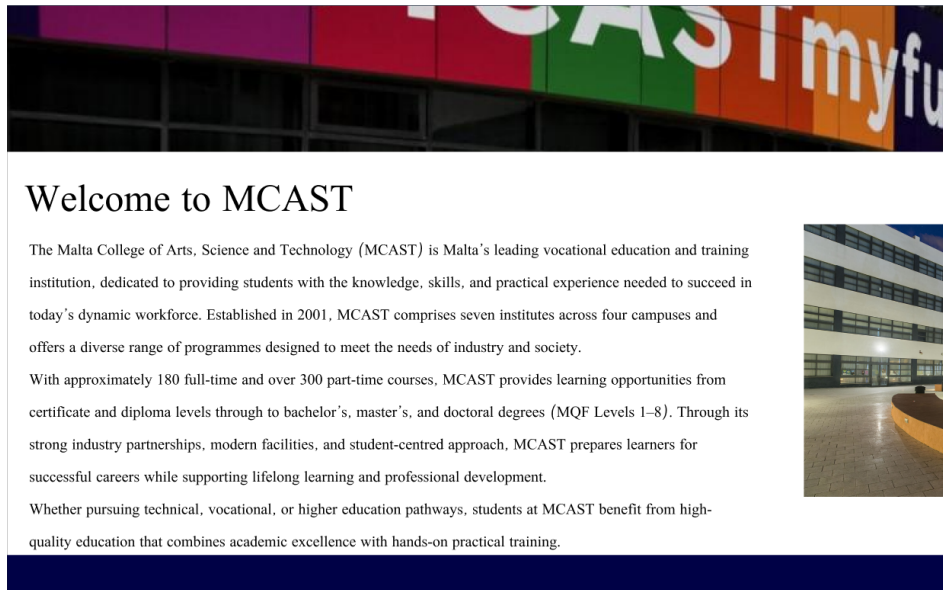
## Imagery



General Images: 429 x 286 px



Hero Banner (Home Page): 1280 x 263 px

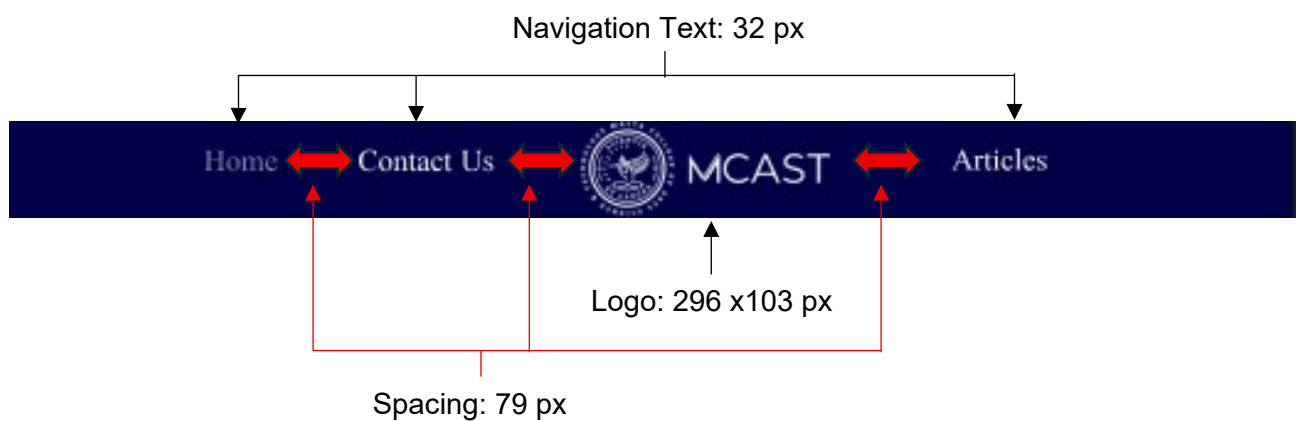


Title: 346 x 84 px

Paragraphs: 761 x 329 px

Font: Times New Roman

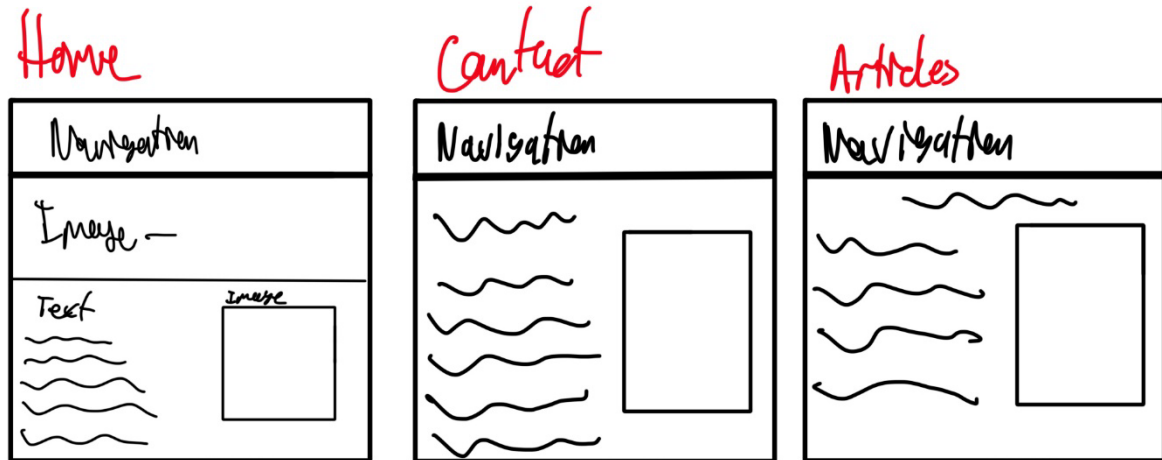
## Navigation Tool Bar



## Bottom Tool Bar



## Sketch



## Icons - Fontawesome



`<i class="fa-brands fa-facebook-f"></i>`

44 x 40 px



`<i class="fa-brands fa-square-instagram"></i>`

54 x 54 px



`<i class="fa-brands fa-x-twitter"></i>`

49 x 47 px



`class="fa-brands fa-linkedin"></i>`

54 x 52 px



<i class="fa-brands fa-youtube"></i>

45 x 57 px



<i class="fa-solid fa-location-crosshairs"></i>



<i class="fa-solid fa-envelope"></i>



<i class="fa-solid fa-phone"></i>

## Hi-Fidelity Mock Up

